

Mobile Banking App Login Outage - Identity Provider Certificate Expiry

Meridian Commercial Bank - Internal Document

doc_id:	INC-2026-07-08-006
document_type:	incident
department:	retail_banking
access_level:	internal
created_date:	2026-07-08
severity:	high
status:	resolved

Summary

On 2026-07-08, customers were unable to log in to the Meridian mobile banking app for 53 minutes due to an expired TLS certificate on the internal Identity Provider (IdP) token-signing endpoint. This incident is unrelated to the payments platform and is included here as a contrasting non-payments example.

Timeline

- 06:00 - IdP token-signing certificate expires (renewal automation job had failed silently three weeks prior).
- 06:00 - Mobile app login requests begin failing with certificate validation errors on the client side.
- 06:12 - Elevated login-failure-rate alert fires.
- 06:20 - On-call identifies the expired certificate via IdP service logs.
- 06:35 - Emergency certificate reissued and deployed.
- 06:53 - Login success rate returns to baseline.

Root Cause

The automated certificate renewal job silently failed three weeks before expiry due to an unrelated IAM permissions change that revoked the renewal service account's access to the certificate authority. No alert existed for renewal job failures, only for certificate expiry itself, which did not fire until the day of expiry.

Impact

- Mobile app login failures for 53 minutes affecting an estimated 22,000 customer sessions.
- Web banking and card transactions were unaffected (separate IdP integration).

Resolution

- Emergency certificate reissued.
- Added a dedicated alert for certificate renewal job failures (not just expiry).

Action Items

1. Add renewal-job-failure alerting for all automated certificate rotation jobs (Owner: Identity Platform, Due: 2026-07-22).
2. Audit IAM permission changes for downstream effects on automation service accounts before rollout (Owner: Security, Due: 2026-08-05).

3. Reduce certificate validity period and increase renewal lead time to catch failures earlier (Owner: Identity Platform, Due: 2026-08-15).